David Blakeslee

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EMPLOYMENT

Associate Professor of Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi	2021 – present
Assistant Professor of Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi	2013 – 2021

ADMINISTRATIVE ROLES

Associate Program Head, Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi	2026 – present
Chair, Economics Junior Faculty Search Committee, New York University Abu Dhabi	2026 – 27

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Columbia University	2013
M.Phil. Economics, Columbia University	2010
M.A. Economics, Columbia University	2009
M.I.A. International Economics, Columbia University, SIPA	2007
A.L.B. Economics, Harvard University	2004

RESEARCH

Published Papers

1. "Might India's Use of Groundwater Be Weakly Sustainable?" *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* (with Mathilde Degois, Ram Fishman, and Esha Zaveri) 2026.
2. "Economic Factors Mediate the Impact of Drought on Farmer Suicides in India," *Global Environmental Change* (with Ram Fishman, Deepak Malghan, and Yoav Rothler) 2024.
3. "Irrigation and the Spatial Pattern of Local Economic Development in India," *Journal of Development Economics* (with Aaditya Dar, Ram Fishman, Samreen Malik, Heitor Pelegrina, and Karan Singh) 2022.
4. "Land Rezoning and Structural Transformation in Rural India: Evidence from the Industrial Areas Program," *World Bank Economic Review* (with Ritam Chaurey, Ram Fishman, and Samreen Malik) 2022.
5. "In the Heat of the Moment: Economic and Non-Economic Drivers of the Weather-Crime Relationship," *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization* (with Ritam Chaurey, Ram Fishman, Deepak Malghan, and Samreen Malik) 2021.
6. "Way Down in the Hole: Adaptation to Long-Term Water Loss in Rural India," *American Economic Review* (with Ram Fishman and Veena Srinivasan) 2020.
7. "Delivering Education to the Underserved through a Public-Private Partnership in Pakistan," *Review of Economics and Statistics* (with Felipe Barrera, Matthew Hoover, Leigh Linden, Dhushyanth Raju, and Stephen Ryan) 2020.

8. "Politics and Public Goods in Developing Countries: Evidence from the Assassination of Rajiv Gandhi," *Journal of Public Economics* 2018.
9. "Weather Shocks, Agriculture, and Crime: Evidence from India," *Journal of Human Resources* (with Ram Fishman) 2018.

Working Papers

1. "Clean Air in the Classroom: Environmental Inputs and Human Capital Formation," Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Development Economics* (with Nitin Kumar Bharti, Samreen Malik, T. Naeem, and T. Walter) 2025.
2. "Ethno-nationalist Mobilization and the Rise of the BJP," 2019.

Works in Progress

1. "Using Scarce Water Efficiently: Can Centralized Irrigation Projects Make a Comeback?" (with Ram Fishman and Dan Oziel)

Grants

"Using Scarce Water Efficiently: Can Centralized Irrigation Projects Make a Comeback?" (with Ram Fishman and Dan Oziel)

REFEREE WORK

American Economic Review; Journal of Political Economy; Quarterly Journal of Economics; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Urban Economics; World Development; Journal of Comparative Economics; Economics of Education Review; American Journal of Agricultural Economics; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; World Bank Economic Review; Weather, Climate, and Society

TEACHING

NYU Stern Executive MBA, Abu Dhabi

2026–27	Global Economy

New York University Abu Dhabi

2026–27	Capstone Coordinator, Economics Capstone
2025–26	Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring)
2024–25	Economics of International Development (Masters Level)
2023–24	Economics of International Development (Masters Level, January Term); Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring)
2022–23	Economics of International Development (Masters Level); Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring)
2021–22	Development Economics; Economics of International Development (Masters Level)
2020–21	Development Economics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Economics of International Development (Masters Level)
2019–20	Development Economics; Public Economics
2018–19	Development Economics; Directed Study
2017–18	Development Economics; Statistics for the Social Sciences

2016–17	Intermediate Macroeconomics; Principles of Macroeconomics; Directed Study
2015–16	Development Economics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Statistics for the Social Sciences; Principles of Macroeconomics (Summer)
2014–15	Intermediate Macroeconomics
2013–14	Development Economics; Public Economics